

# Parent Guide — primary / module-08-yoga

IKS Curriculum

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### Parent Guide — Module 8: Yoga for Little Ones

**Your child's age:** Primary (Grades 3–5) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 30 min (~12 min movement each)

#### What your child is learning

Five safe yoga poses + one breathing practice: - **Tāḍāsana** (mountain) — standing tall - **Vṛkṣāsana** (tree, like a flamingo) — balance - **Balāsana** (child's pose, like a sleeping puppy) — rest - **Cat-Cow** (mārjārī-bidalāsana) — spine wave - **Bhrāmarī** (bumblebee breath) — humming exhale

Plus the Sanskrit words *yoga* (to join), *āsana* (posture), *prāṇa* (breath).

#### Safety — what we DO NOT do at this age

- **No** headstands or shoulder stands (inversions).
- **No** big backbends.
- **No** holding the breath.
- **No** competitive holding (“see who can stay longest”).
- **Always** an opt-out — your child can sit out any pose, no questions.

If your child has asthma, a recent injury, or any other condition, the school has a medical opt-out form. Please complete it before Day 1.

#### What to expect this fortnight

**Movement and animal sounds.** Day 4 is “Cat-Cow” with optional meows and moos. Day 5 is “Bumblebee Breath” with audible humming. Giggles are part of the practice.

**At home:** - Stand like a mountain for 60 seconds before brushing teeth. - Tree pose for 10 seconds per side. - Bumblebee breath: 5 hums before bed.

**Creative project (Days 7–10):** Your child invents their OWN yoga pose, gives it a name, and teaches the class for 1 minute on Day 10. Sticker for everyone.

## How to help

**Helpful:** - Do the poses *with* your child. Mountain pose for 60 seconds before bed = great way to wind down. - For balance poses (tree), don't worry about wobble. Wobble is what balance learning looks like. - For the breathing: model slow exhale. "Breathe out slowly, like you're cooling soup." - For their invented pose: support, don't direct. Whatever they create is the right answer.

**Not helpful:** - Pushing them deeper into a pose. - Adjusting their alignment with your hands (let the teacher do that). - Filming and posting to social media — yoga is a personal practice, not a performance.

## A note on yoga and religion

Yoga has religious roots in India. Many families practise it devotionally. **In school we teach it as physical practice with attention to breath** — not as religion. We honour the religious dimensions but don't centre them.

If your family doesn't want your child to participate, the school will arrange a written observation alternative.

## What success looks like

By the end of the module, your child can: - Do 5 safe yoga poses at home without help. - Hum bumblebee breath when they need to settle. - Teach you their invented pose.

## Want to go deeper?

Middle band (Grade 6–8) teaches Sūrya Namaskāra (Sun Salutation) and Patañjali's eight-limb framework. Preview: [curriculum/middle/module-08-yoga/README.md](#).

# 10-Day Lesson Plan

## Module 8 (Primary) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

### At a glance (30-min sessions)

| Day | Title            | Pose / Practice    | Animal cue     |
|-----|------------------|--------------------|----------------|
| 1   | What is Yoga?    | tāḍāsana           | mountain       |
| 2   | The Tree         | vṛkṣāsana          | flamingo       |
| 3   | Child's Rest     | balāsana           | sleeping puppy |
| 4   | Cat-Cow          | mārjārī-bidālāsana | cat + cow      |
| 5   | Bumblebee Breath | bhrāmarī           | buzzing bee    |

| Day | Title            | Pose / Practice   | Animal cue  |
|-----|------------------|-------------------|-------------|
| 6   | Animal Yoga Walk | All 5 in a flow   | —           |
| 7   | Invent a Pose    | Creative time     | child's own |
| 8   | Project Day 1    | Design + name     | —           |
| 9   | Project Day 2    | Practise teaching | —           |
| 10  | Pose Showcase    | Teach your pose   | —           |

### Daily structure (30 min)

| Time   | What                             |
|--------|----------------------------------|
| 3 min  | Settle on mat, 5 breaths         |
| 5 min  | Story / new pose introduction    |
| 12 min | Practice                         |
| 5 min  | Reflection / animal sounds / fun |
| 5 min  | Tāḍāsana close + namaste         |

### What children leave with

- 5 safe poses they can do daily at home.
- Sanskrit words *yoga*, *āsana*, *prāṇa* — recognised, not memorised.
- Bumblebee breath as a calming tool.
- One invented pose with a name.
- The habit of starting and ending with the mountain.